surveillance—the USA Freedom Act, passed by the US House of Representatives in 2014. Also as a result of NSA activities coming to light, corporations, foreign nations, and individuals began taking measures to evade government eavesdropping, including increasing the use of computer encryption.

Conflicts

Although a majority of Americans believed they had a right to know about the secret programs revealed in the NSA documents Snowden leaked, a majority of the public believes Snowden acted illegally and should be prosecuted. The US government charged Snowden with theft and two violations of the Espionage Act and canceled his passport. Knowing he would be arrested if he stepped foot in the United States, Snowden sought, and was granted, asylum in Russia after applying for asylum in 20 other countries. Many in the US considered him a traitor and a thief and thought he should have chosen a different way to voice his concerns.

Quote

"It's really hard to take that step. Not only do I believe in something, I believe in it enough that I'm willing to set my own life on fire and burn it to the ground."
—*Edward Snowden*

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